12-28 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Stranger on the Subway Who Returned My Maths Exercise Book Two Weeks Later

① On the evening of **Tuesday 14 December 2027**, I did something I had never done in my thirteen years on the Longhua Line subway: **I left my maths exercise book on the seat beside me**, and walked out of the carriage at Longhua South Station without ever looking back. The book was not a small thing. It was the one cream-coloured hard-cover notebook that Mum had bought me for my thirteenth birthday in August, the one I had been writing in every school day for four and a half months, with **118 pages of my own careful pencil work**, including every Grade-8 maths test I had done since September, and — on the last written page — a small half-finished version of a particularly hard quadratic-equation problem that Mr Qin had given us the day before. I had put the book down on the empty seat at Jianguo Road Station to take out my water bottle. I drank the water. I put the water bottle back. I stepped out at Longhua South at **18:03**. **I forgot the book.** I only realised what I had done eleven minutes later, at **18:14**, when I reached home and opened my school bag to look for it. Mum saw my face and did not need to ask. The book was gone.

② That night I barely slept. I phoned the subway line's Lost and Found office the next morning at exactly **08:30**, the minute it opened, and a kind tired voice took my details — Grade 8, Longhua Line, evening of 14 December, cream hard-cover book, reward not expected — and gave me a small claim number: **LF-2712-0417**. For the next two days I phoned the Lost and Found office three times a day, at 09:00, 12:30 and 17:00. Each time the kind tired voice said, gently, *"No, miss. Nothing matching your description yet. We will phone you if it comes in."* By Friday 17 December, I quietly gave up hope. Mum did not tell me to give up; she simply said, one evening, *"Yiran, 118 pages of your own careful work is a big loss. But if the book is not returned, we will buy another one. Not the same. A different one. And you will start again. That is not the worst thing in the world."* I nodded, but I did not really believe her yet.

③ **Eleven days passed without news.** I started, slowly and unhappily, a second maths exercise book — a plain blue one — and tried not to think about the old cream one too often. I told myself it had probably been swept into the evening rubbish at the subway cleaning station, or taken home by a tired adult who mistook it for scrap paper. On the evening of **Monday 27 December 2027**, at **19:40**, my mother's phone rang in the kitchen. She answered. I heard her say, very slowly, *"Yes… yes, that is my daughter. Yes, Yiran… I see… yes, thank you so much… tomorrow evening? Longhua South, exit A, 18:30? Yes.*

She will be there. Thank you, sir. Thank you so, so much." She hung up. Her eyes were a little wet. She said, *"Yiran. A man has your book. He will return it tomorrow."*

④ On **Tuesday 28 December 2027** at exactly **18:25**, five minutes early, I stood at Exit A of Longhua South Station with Mum half a step behind me. The winter air was sharp. At **18:30**, a man walked up — perhaps 58 years old, wearing a plain grey work jacket, carrying a small black plastic bag in his gloved right hand. He looked at me for about two seconds and said, in a gentle country-accented voice, *"Little student. Your book."* He took the cream-coloured exercise book out of the plastic bag. **It had been cleaned.** The cover, which had been faintly dusty from the subway floor, was now wiped and almost shining. A small loose page — the one with the half-finished quadratic-equation problem — had been **carefully flattened back into its place** with what looked like a new piece of clear tape. He handed the book to me with both hands, the way Chinese grandfathers hand letters to young children. Mum tried to give him a small thank-you envelope she had prepared. He **firmly stepped back**, raised both his hands, shook his head once, and said, *"No money. My granddaughter is Grade 7 next year. I only know what this book is worth to a small student. You keep it. I did not help for money."*

⑤ I did not say anything at first; my throat felt too thick. After a small second I bowed — properly, the way Granny had taught me — and said, *"Uncle. Thank you. I do not know what to say."* The man smiled gently, and then quietly explained: he is a **night-shift cleaner** at Longhua Line Subway Station, and every evening after the last train at 23:50, his team cleans the carriages. He had found my book on the evening of 14 December, inside seat 7 of carriage 4. He had put it aside in the cleaners' staff-room, thinking someone would report it. When no one came, he had **gone by himself, on his own lunch break**, to the Lost and Found office to report it and leave his phone number. When he heard a small girl had been phoning three times a day looking for it, he decided he would return it personally — and that the book should be given back **clean**. He had spent, he said, *"not much time — maybe ten minutes with a soft cloth, and two minutes with the tape."* Ten minutes. Two minutes. For a stranger's child.

⑥ I asked, quietly, *"Uncle, what is your name?"* He paused, and then said, *"Little student, a name is not important. If you really want to thank me, when you are grown and in a hurry on the subway one day, and you see another tired small student who has lost something, slow down for two minutes and help her pick it up. That is the only thank-you I want."* Then he gave one small nod to my mother, turned, and walked quietly back into the station. His grey work jacket disappeared into the evening crowd within fifteen seconds, and I realised, in a kind of quiet panic, that I would very possibly never see him again — and that that was, somehow, exactly the right ending.

⑦ That night at home, I opened the cream-coloured exercise book to the last written page and, under the half-finished quadratic-equation problem, wrote one small sentence in my neatest pencil handwriting: *"Book returned 28 Dec 2027, by a kind night cleaner at Longhua South who asked for no name and no money. Yiran, 13 years old, will one day slow down for another small student in a hurry."* Then I closed the book and placed it on

my desk, the cleanest I have ever left it. I understood, for the first time that evening, a small sentence Granny had once whispered to me a year ago in her kitchen and that I had not fully understood then: **kindness does not always come from people whose names we learn. Some of the warmest kindness in a cold city comes, quietly, from strangers who refuse to tell us their names, and who ask only that we one day pass the same small kindness, silently, to somebody else's child.**

注释： carriage 车厢；Lost and Found 失物招领处；quadratic equation 一元二次方程；night-shift 夜班的；scrap paper 废纸

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What exactly did the narrator lose on the subway, and how did she realise it was missing?

A. She lost a small snack on the subway and realised this at home.
B. On the evening of Tuesday 14 December 2027, the narrator did something she had never done in her thirteen years on the Longhua Line: she left her maths exercise book — the cream-coloured hard-cover notebook Mum bought for her thirteenth birthday in August — on the seat beside her and walked out at Longhua South at 18:03 without looking back; the book was 118 pages of her own careful pencil work from four and a half months including every Grade-8 maths test since September and a half-finished quadratic-equation problem Mr Qin had given the day before; she had placed it on the seat at Jianguo Road to take out her water bottle, drank the water, put the bottle back, stepped out at 18:03, and only realised the loss eleven minutes later at 18:14 at home when opening her school bag; Mum saw her face and did not need to ask.
C. She lost her wallet and bank card on the subway but recovered them within an hour.
D. She lost her subway card at Longhua South and a guard returned it immediately.

2. What actions did the narrator take after losing the book, and what did Mum say?

A. The narrator did nothing at all and ignored the loss.
B. The narrator phoned the Lost and Found office at exactly 08:30 the next morning (opening time), giving her details — Grade 8, Longhua Line, evening of 14 December, cream hard-cover book, reward not expected — and received the claim number LF-2712-0417; for the next two days she phoned three times a day at 09:00, 12:30, and 17:00, each time hearing "No, miss. Nothing matching your description yet. We will phone you if it comes in."; by Friday 17 December she quietly gave up hope, and Mum — who did not tell her to give up — simply said one evening "Yiran, 118 pages of your own careful work is a big loss. But if the book is not returned, we will buy another one. Not the same. A different one. And you will start again. That is not the worst thing in the world."
C. The narrator immediately filed a police report and sued the subway company.
D. Mum told the narrator never to mention the book again and bought a new one that night.

3. How did the stranger present the returned book at Exit A of Longhua South on 28 December?

A. He threw the book on the ground without speaking and walked away quickly.
B. He mailed the book in a torn envelope with no note.
C. On Tuesday 28 December 2027 at exactly 18:25, five minutes early, the narrator stood at Exit A with Mum half a step behind; at 18:30 a man of about 58 in a plain grey work jacket, carrying a small black plastic bag in his gloved right hand, walked up, looked at her for about two seconds, and said in a gentle country-accented voice "Little student. Your book."; he took out the cream-coloured exercise book — it had been cleaned, the cover wiped and almost shining, and the small loose page with the half-finished quadratic-equation had been carefully flattened back into place with what looked like a new piece of clear tape — and handed it to her with both hands the way Chinese grandfathers hand letters to small children; when Mum tried to give him a small thank-you envelope, he firmly stepped back, raised both hands, shook his head once and said "No money. My granddaughter is Grade 7 next year. I only know what this book is worth to a small student. You keep it. I did not help for money."
D. He demanded a large cash reward and threatened to keep the book.

4. What did the stranger explain about how he found the book, and what was his only request?

A. He said he had sold the book on the second-hand market before returning it.
B. He refused to explain anything and told the narrator not to ask questions.
C. He said he is a night-shift cleaner at Longhua Line Subway Station whose team cleans the carriages after the last train at 23:50; he found the book on 14 December inside seat 7 of carriage 4, set it aside in the staff-room thinking someone would report it, and when no one did he went by himself on his own lunch break to the Lost and Found to report it and leave his phone number; when he heard a small girl had been phoning three times a day he decided to return it personally and clean — spending "not much time — maybe ten minutes with a soft cloth and two minutes with the tape"; when asked his name, he said "A name is not important. If you really want to thank me, when you are grown and in a hurry on the subway one day and see another tired small student who has lost something, slow down for two minutes and help her pick it up. That is the only thank-you I want."
D. He asked for the narrator's family address and contact details as a reward.

5. What is the main understanding the narrator reached that night at home?

A. The best way to get a book returned is to offer very large rewards in cash.
B. Kindness is always given by people who insist on their names being known and repaid publicly.
C. That night at home, the narrator opened the cream-coloured exercise book to the last written page and, under the half-finished quadratic-equation, wrote in her neatest pencil "Book returned 28 Dec 2027, by a kind night cleaner at Longhua South who asked for no

name and no money. Yiran, 13 years old, will one day slow down for another small student in a hurry."; she understood, for the first time, a sentence Granny had once whispered to her a year earlier in her kitchen and that she had not fully understood then — kindness does not always come from people whose names we learn; some of the warmest kindness in a cold city comes quietly from strangers who refuse to tell us their names and who ask only that we one day pass the same small kindness silently to somebody else's child.
D. The narrator decided never to ride the subway again.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段
【解析】"12.14 晚 18:03 忘书 / 米色 118 页 / 18:14 到家才觉察"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段
【解析】"08:30 报失 / LF-2712-0417 / 每天 3 电 / 妈温言 118 页可重来"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段
【解析】"18:30 老人灰夹克 / 书洗净 / 胶带贴页 / 两手递 / 拒谢金"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 + 第⑥段
【解析】"夜班清洁 / 14 日 4 车 7 座 / 午休报失 / 10+2 分钟 / 只求日后帮他人"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑦段

【解析】"本上记字／奶奶早言／善意或出无名之人／只求默默传递"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。